

## HISTORY HACK · DOCUMENT-BASED QUESTION

# Civil Liberties and the Home Front in World War I

**US.27** — Identify and explain the impact of the following on World War I (T.C.A. § 49-6-1006): • Trench warfare • Use of new weapons and technology • John J. Pershing • Harlem Hell Fighters • Alvin C. York

**US.28** — Analyze the political, economic, and social ramifications of World War I on the home front, including: • Role played by women and minorities • Voluntary rationing • Committee on Public Information (i.e., Creel Committee) • Opposition by conscientious objectors • Schenck v. United States decision

Name \_\_\_\_\_ Class \_\_\_\_\_ Date \_\_\_\_\_

**Directions.** Read the two documents below. Then write a well-organized essay addressing the following question: How did the U.S. government's management of the home front during World War I reveal fundamental tensions between national security and the constitutional rights of American citizens? Your essay must: — Apply HIPP analysis to both documents — Construct a clear argument about the tension between security and liberty — Incorporate outside knowledge of specific home-front policies and their effects — Evaluate whether the balance struck was justified given the wartime context

## The sources

### Document 1

Espionage Act, June 15, 1917, Section 3 — Statutes at Large of the United States, public domain

“Whoever, when the United States is at war, shall willfully make or convey false reports or false statements with intent to interfere with the operation or success of the military or naval forces of the United States or to promote the success of its enemies... shall be punished by a fine of not more than \$10,000 or imprisonment for not more than twenty years, or both... Any newspaper, magazine, or other publication... containing any matter advocating or urging treason, insurrection, or forcible resistance to any law of the United States is hereby declared to be nonmailable.”

## SOURCE IT — DOCUMENT 1

**H** — Historical context

What was happening when  
this was made?

**I** — Intended audience

Who was meant to read or  
hear it?

**P** — Purpose

What was it trying to make  
the audience do or think?

**P** — Point of view

Who is speaking, and how  
does that shape it?

## Document 2

Schenck v. United States, Supreme Court of the United States, March 3, 1919 — public domain (U.S. government document)

“The most stringent protection of free speech would not protect a man in falsely shouting fire in a theatre and causing a panic. It does not even protect a man from an injunction against uttering words that may have all the effect of force... The question in every case is whether the words used are used in such circumstances and are of such a nature as to create a clear and present danger that they will bring about the substantive evils that Congress has a right to prevent.” — Justice Oliver Wendell Holmes, writing for the Court”

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The question

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2. Justice Oliver Wendell Holmes, writing for the Court

Plan your answer

|            |  |
|------------|--|
| Your claim |  |
|------------|--|

| Source            | Evidence you will use | Why it supports your claim |
|-------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------|
| Document 1        |                       |                            |
| Document 2        |                       |                            |
| Outside knowledge |                       |                            |

### Write your response

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History Hack · TroopToTeacher Technologies. Tennessee Academic Standards 2027-28. classroom-formative · pre-field-test — this activity has not been field-tested and its scoring guide is not calibrated.